

Reflection We can look at the parable in today's Gospel passage from the perspective of its historical context and from the perspective of its modern application.

To take the historical context: Who are the various participants in the story? The landowner is God the Father. The tenants are the chief priests and the elders of the people to whom the parable is addressed. The servants sent to collect the produce of the vineyard are the prophets. And finally, the son whom the landowner sent and who was rejected utterly and who was thrown out and killed by the tenants is Jesus.

This was a stark warning to the religious leaders of Jesus' day. They had rejected the prophets whom God had sent and they were rejecting Jesus and he was warning them that there would be dire consequences. Out of their own mouths they condemned themselves. He asked them what the landowner would do to the wicked tenants and they answered: 'He will bring those wretches to a wretched end.' Then having completed the telling of the story and having heard the response of the chief priests and the elders, Jesus opened their eyes to its meaning. He told them that he was the stone rejected by the builders who became the keystone. And then, lest there be any doubt he announced to them: 'I tell you, then, that the Kingdom of God will be taken from you given to a people who will produce its fruit.'

No doubt the chief priests and the elders were furious at being compared to faithless tenants; and no doubt they were furious at having been made to condemn themselves.

Now to the present day application: At a remove of two millennia we can feel quite smug and happily join-in in the condemnation of the wretched tenants. But we had better be careful. Could any of the things said to or about the tenants apply to us? Have we received God's messengers and listened to them. Have we received his Son with respect and reverence and listened to him and acted on his call to us? As people in whom the Holy Spirit dwells since our baptism and Confirmation, have we produced the fruits of love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, and self-control which are the Lord's due and delivered them to him?

In as much as the parable was a wake-up call, so to speak, to the chief priests and the elders of the people of Jesus' day so it is to us.

Saints of the Week

Mon 5th Bl Albert, St Faustina
Tue 6th St Bruno
Wed 7th Our Lady of the Rosary
Fri 9th St Denis, St John Newman

Church of St Mary Magdalene,
 Monaleen Road, Castletroy, V94 E3C8
 'We seek to create an inclusive community,
 where all are welcome'

Priests of the Parish
 Canon Gerard Garrett, Fr Daniel Tomasik
 Fr Peter Claver Emeke Eze, Fr Robbert Coffey

Parish Secretary, Mrs Brid Hession
 Parish office Tues, Wedn& Thurs 7.45am—12.45pm
 Tel: 061 338340 / Email: info@monaleenparish.ie

Mass Intentions

Sat 3rd Oct 7pm	Patrick & Noreen McCoy RIP A Ann McGrath RIP (MM)
Sun 4th Oct 10am 11.30am	Bill Leahy RIP (3rd A)
Tue 6th Oct 9.45am	Christine Smyth RIP Rec Dec
Wed 7th Oct 9.45am	Christine Smyth RIP Rec Dec Special Intention
Thurs 8th Oct 9.45am	
Fri 9th Oct 9.45am	Patsy Barrett (Birth Rem) Catherine & Lawrence O'Mahony Peig & Moss Horgan RIP (A)
Sat 10th Oct 7pm	Leo Morrison RIP (9th A)
Sun 11th Oct 10 am 11.30am	Tom O'Connor RIP (A)

LIMERICK MENTAL HEALTH WEEK
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 SATAKIELI (FINNISH MUSIC)
 ST. JOHN'S CATHEDRAL
 CHOIR

St. John's
 Cathedral
 7:30pm – 9:30pm

Check out our website for all LMHW events running 4th-10th October
 Doras x

YOUNG ADULT PRAYER MEETING
 by Youth 2000

Ages 16-35

EVERY MONDAY AT 7:30 PM
 at the Crying Chapel of Our
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PRAYER AND SOCIAL
 For more info contact
 Aisling on 0877526111

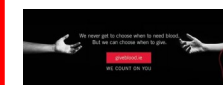
TOUR AND TALK ON THE WINDOWS
 OF
ST. JOHN'S CATHEDRAL
 In conjunction with the
 Centre for Irish German Studies
 and St John's Parish
 BY
GEORGE LEE
 Saturday
 17th October 2026
 12.30pm
 St. John's Cathedral
 Explore the stories, symbolism
 and craftsmanship of the
 cathedral's remarkable windows
 with George Lee.

Centre for
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All are welcome

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Castletroy Park Hotel Mon 5th October
 4:20pm – 7:40pm

Lim Racecourse Patrickswell Tues 6th October
 4:20pm – 7:40pm

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 hour but could save a life. Call 1800 222 111 to book